

Analysis of Presidential Addresses

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Trusted AI

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1 Report

This project was to conduct analysis of inaugural addresses of presidents throughout American history. These included sentiment analysis and word clouds. These presidents were:

- Thomas Jefferson (1801)
- Abraham Lincoln (1861)
- Woodrow Wilson (1913)
- Harry Truman (1949)
- Ronald Reagan (1981)

The models used to analyze these addresses were VADER and TextBlob, two text analysis models:

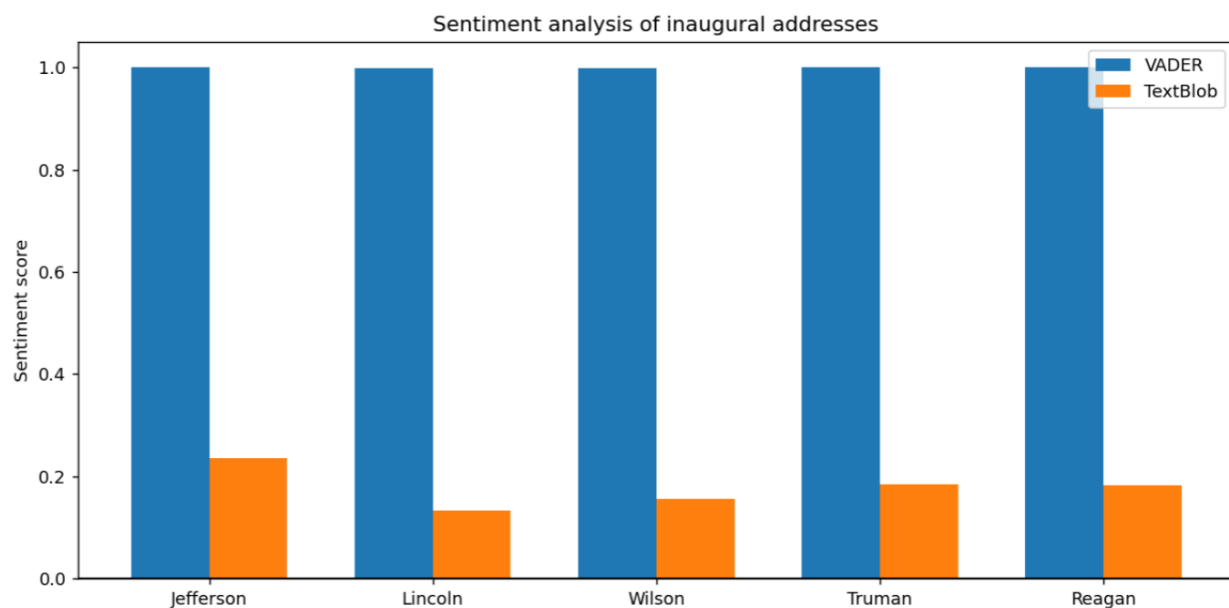


Figure 1: Sentiment analysis by presidential address

For sentiment analysis, the results were all very similar for both models (quite positive with VADER and somewhat positive with TextBlob, probably because presidents use similar rhetoric and want their speeches to sound positive. TextBlob's metrics were more varied than VADER's and showed Lincoln as having the least positive sentiment. This makes sense because Lincoln's address was given near the beginning of the American Civil War. Of the word clouds, my favorite was Truman's:

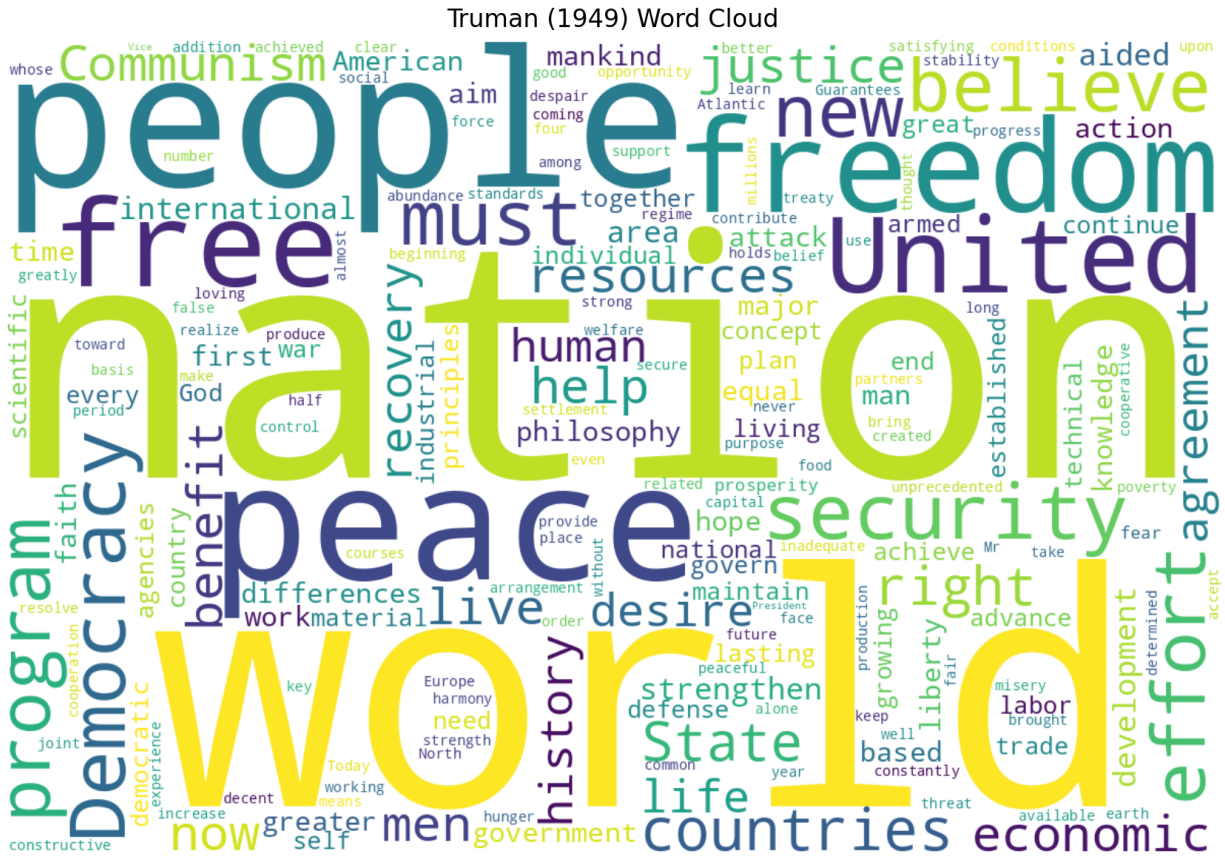


Figure 2: Truman's word cloud

This one makes sense because in 1949 WWII had just ended and the United States was the only major power left relatively intact, and the United Nations was forming to prevent another world war. As such, words like "world", "peace", and "people" are very prominent.